

SALES TRAINING DEBRIEF · SESSION 2

Big Energy. Better Research. Stop Hunting Excuses.

Session led by Corie Dawson, Director

Friday 8 May 2026 · Internal sales-team summary

The thesis in one line

Wednesday was about the choreography of a pitch. Today was about the operator running it. The same scripts in a low-energy, under-researched, under-believing rep produce nothing. The deal is mostly won before you walk in the room — by your preparation, your belief, and the energy you bring.

“It ain’t over till I win.” — Corie

1. Energy is the multiplier on everything else

The session opened with a hard reset on pace. Walking in slow, sounding tentative, “lingering around like a bad smell” — these are the tells that lose deals before the pitch even begins. The customer matches your energy. If you turn up at a 4, they meet you at a 4. If you turn up at a 9, they get pulled into your atmosphere.

“There’s a vacuum I create. People get caught up in it. The question is: do you want to sell fast or sell slow?” — Corie

The magnet model

Imagine you have a magnet on each shoulder. One pulls in success — the right clients, the right colleagues, the right opportunities. The other repels failure — the wrong fits, the time-wasters, the energy drains. Your job all day, every day, is to keep both magnets active. People who don’t curate this end up with a mixture of everything and anything, and they wonder why they feel exhausted.

Effort vs show

There is a critical difference between putting on a show and putting in effort. A show is superficial — the customer can smell it. Effort is visible work the customer benefits from: research, preparation, recall, follow-through. Show wears you out. Effort compounds.

“I don’t put on a show for anyone. What I put on is effort. If the client feels that you’re moving at a certain rate in the dialogue — they react.” — Corie

2. Solutions vs excuses — the only frame that matters

Your brain is wired to protect your ego. After every lost deal it will deliver you a list of reasons it wasn't your fault: bad timing, the market, the client was tight, they had a coach, they wanted to think. These reasons feel comforting because they let you face yourself in the mirror. They are also the single biggest barrier to ever improving.

Corie's frame: there are two modes you can run in.

Hunting for excuses (loser mode)	Hunting for solutions (winner mode)
Builds your case for why losing wasn't your fault.	Builds your case for why next time will be different.
Feels safer in the short term.	Feels uncomfortable in the short term.
Drains energy. Reasoning is exhausting.	Generates energy. Solving is generative.
Keeps your paycheck the same.	Changes your paycheck.
"It's not an excuse, it's a reason."	"I got it wrong. Here are three things to try."

"Excuses are reasons in disguise. It's the ego cloaking up. Same thing. You didn't get what you wanted." — Corie

The takeaway is not "be more positive." It is: when something doesn't close, your only allowed next thought is "what is the solution next time?" Reasons are forbidden.

3. Research is the foundation — know more about their business than they do

A long stretch of the session was spent on a deal where the rep couldn't answer basic questions about the prospect: average job value, jobs per day, monthly turnover. The verdict was direct — if you don't know their business, you can't close them. Period.

"I knew more about their business than they did themselves. That's how I got 11 deals in a day." — Corie

The 5 P's

Prior Preparation Prevents Poor Performance. Treat this as the law. If you walk into the pitch without doing your homework, you've already lost — the rest is just theatre.

Always pitch the highest end of the range

When estimating a prospect's turnover, profitability, headcount, or anything else — go to the top of the plausible range, every time. There is no upside to going in low.

- If you assume a low number, your brain treats them as a small client. You under-pitch. You under-believe.
- If you assume a high number, your brain frames them as a serious operator. You pitch with conviction. You hit the right anchor.

- Reps under-state their own numbers to salespeople — multiply what they tell you by ~2x as a default rule of thumb.

What "knowing their business" actually means

Before any pitch, you should be able to recite, from memory:

- Number of staff (and roles, if known)
- Number of vehicles, sites, or other operating units
- Average job value or transaction size
- Estimated monthly and annual turnover (top of the range)
- Estimated profit margin
- What "busy" looks like — frequency of jobs
- Their main competitor and what that competitor charges
- Their existing digital footprint — branded vs non-branded traffic, backlinks, current rankings

4. Rapport is what comes out of your mouth that was already in their head

Forget surface-level rapport-building. Real rapport is built when you reflect back facts about the prospect's business that they assumed only they knew. They feel understood instantly — and trust collapses into the conversation in seconds.

"The information that's in their head, comes out your mouth. That is a way to consummate instant rapport." — Corie

This is only possible if you've done the research in Section 3. The two are inseparable.

5. The pre-meeting confirmation call — high energy, low minutes

A short, deliberate phone call before the actual pitch meeting. Its job is two-fold: gather any final data points you're missing, and condition the prospect to look forward to seeing you.

How it should sound

"Hey [name], Lucas here. I'm busy, I know you're busy. I'm prepping for Friday's meeting and doing some keyword research and projections on AdWords versus SEO. Three quick questions while I'm doing the calculations: roughly how many jobs per day, what's your average job value, and who are you up against locally? Perfect — speak Friday."

Rules

- High energy from the first second. You are setting the tone for Friday.
- Maximum three questions. Get in, get out.

- You hang up first. If they say "I've got to go" before you've wrapped, you've overstayed.
- Reference real preparation work ("doing keyword research", "running projections") — it signals competence.
- Use a power word to close: "perfect," "great," "fantastic" — never "ok" or "no worries."

When done well, the prospect ends the call thinking: "this person knows what they're doing — I'm looking forward to Friday." Which is exactly the energy you want walking into the room.

6. Power words — the language of high energy

Words have weight. The team's default vocabulary is too soft. Words like "excellent" feel polite but carry no force — Corie called it a 7/10 word. Replace it.

Soft / 7-out-of-10 vocabulary	Power-word vocabulary
"Excellent."	"Perfect." / "Amazing." / "Incredible." / "Superb."
"That sounds good."	"That's a superb opportunity."
"It's \$1,500."	"It's only \$1,500."
"Yeah, ok."	"Perfect — let's go."
"Have a think about it."	"On a 10, where are you sitting?"

The "only" rule

The word "only" before a price makes the number feel small without changing it. "It's only \$1,500." "It's only \$1,050 today." Use it on every price you quote. It costs nothing and it works.

7. When you need to come down, frame it as cleverness — not weakness

Pitch high (Wednesday's rule still stands). If the prospect chokes on the price, do not panic-drop. Use the "silly me" recovery — frame the lower number as your idea, not a concession.

"I'll hold \$1,500. Then towards the end I'll go: silly me — I've got a great idea. We can do this and this, and we don't need that. Gets you under \$900. How's that sound?" — Corie (paraphrased)

Why this works

- You stay in the position of expert solving their problem — not panicked seller dropping their pants.

- The new lower price arrives wrapped in your competence: "I've worked something out for you."
- They feel like they're getting a gift, not getting away with one.
- You retain authority for the next conversation — including any future upsell.

8. The strategic plant — losing the battle, winning the war

When you can't close because the prospect has a competing influence — most often a business coach, a "guy they know" who does cheap websites, or a current vendor — don't fight it head-on. Plant a seed of doubt about the influence, predict the future, and graciously concede the meeting.

How it sounds (business-coach example)

"Look, generally speaking, business coaches don't love this kind of thing — they're focused on getting fees out of you. Have a chat with them. From experience, in three to six months you'll be fed up and you'll come back. That's usually how this plays out."

You're not winning today. You're positioning yourself as the obvious answer for when the prospect's current arrangement falls apart — and you're planting an early-warning thought in their head every time the coach disappoints them.

"If I'm wrong, we don't get the deal. If I'm right, we get the deal — in six months. Either way I've lost nothing." — Corie (paraphrased)

9. Belief in the product is non-negotiable

Sales is energy transfer. If you do not fully believe the product solves the problem, you cannot transfer belief to the customer — no matter how clean the script is. Customers can feel doubt. They will treat your hesitation as a signal that something is wrong with the offer.

"You're pitching but you don't believe it. People don't buy. The results can't lie."
— Corie

Diagnosing your own belief

If your close rate is low and your pitch is technically correct, the gap is almost always belief. Ask yourself honestly:

- Do I think our product actually solves the prospect's problem better than the alternatives?
- Do I believe our process delivers on what we promise?
- Am I confident our results are real and reproducible?

If any of those is a "kind of," you have a research project, not a sales problem. Fix the belief gap before the next pitch. Get the case studies. Talk to delivery. See the work.

10. Your environment shapes your performance

Corie spent time on the principle that the people you spend time with — both inside and outside work — directly shape your performance. Friends who want you to win amplify your energy. Friends who want you to fail (or are quietly pleased when you struggle) drain it before you even start the day.

"You want to focus all your energy around the friendships and people that are serving you. Anything outside that, you're just taking on baggage." — Corie

This isn't about cutting people off ruthlessly. It is about being honest with yourself about who lifts you and who weighs you down — and structuring your time accordingly. The energy you bring to a Friday pitch starts with the company you keep on Wednesday night.

11. Behaviours to change — this week

1. **Run every pitch through "5 P's" before you walk in.** If you can't recite staff count, average job value, monthly turnover, profit, and main competitor — postpone the meeting. Do not wing it.
2. **Default every estimate to the top of the range.** No exceptions. If you don't know — assume the highest plausible number and pitch from there.
3. **Make the pre-meeting confirmation call mandatory.** High energy, three questions, you hang up first. Use it on every booked meeting.
4. **Audit your vocabulary.** Strike "excellent," "ok," "no worries," "yeah" from your sales calls. Replace with "perfect," "amazing," "superb opportunity," "let's go." Add "only" before every price.
5. **Bring 9/10 energy to every meeting.** No matter how the prospect looks on paper. Treat every meeting like it's the most important one of the day.
6. **Replace "reasons we lost" with "next time we will."** After every lost deal, write one sentence — what specifically you will do differently. No analysis of the prospect, no analysis of the market. Just your behaviour.
7. **Audit your belief in the product.** If there's a gap, fix it before next week's pitches. Talk to delivery, see real results, get clarity. You can't transfer belief you don't have.
8. **Use "silly me" instead of dropping the price.** When you need to come down, frame the lower number as your idea — a clever rework, not a concession.
9. **Plant the seed on lost deals.** When you can't win today (because of a coach, a "mate," or a current vendor), graciously concede and predict the future. You're booking the next conversation.

Final reminder. Wednesday gave you the choreography of the pitch. Today gave you the operating system that runs it. Same scripts, different operator, completely different result. The work this week is on the operator.